

CASE STUDY
COFORGE ACQUIRES ENCORA

GROUP 5
PAYAL
KANISHKA
PAHULPREET
ANUSHA
MANNAT
ALISHA
PRIYANSHU

CORE OF CASE

The case is about Coforge acquiring Encora in May 2026

The Important Facts

- **Coforge -** IT services company
- **Encora -** based AI and Digital engineering company
- **Deal Value -** US $2.35 - 2.5 Billion
- **Combine workforce -** Approximately 34,000 employees. Employees spread across India,USA,Latin America and Asia

WORKFORCE FORECASTING FRAMEWORK FOR AI PROJECTS

Q1 .How Should Coforge forecast workforce needs in Ai and Digital engineering post acquisition?



Talent Acquisition & Retention

Culture & Employee Experience + Learning and Development+ Global HR Integration

Question: What strategies can HR use to retain Encora's innovation-driven talent while integrating them into Coforge's global structure?

Problem - Ancora employees fear job losses, role changes, reduced growth opportunities, and losing their existing workplace culture after Forge's acquisition.

Strategies HR can use:

- **Provide clear career growth opportunities**
- **Preserve an innovation-friendly culture**
- **Give employees meaningful AI projects**
- **Involve Encora employees in decision-making**
- **Offer competitive rewards**

Activity : "Global Client Connect"

"Encora employees will be given opportunities to interact with international clients, participate in client meetings, present project updates and understand global customer expectations."

Global Exposure → Skill Development → Engagement → Recognition → Knowledge Sharing → Improved Retention.

0-3 month | **3-6 months** | **6-9 months** | **9-12 months**

Coforge | encora Cultural Integration

People. Cultures. A Stronger Tomorrow.

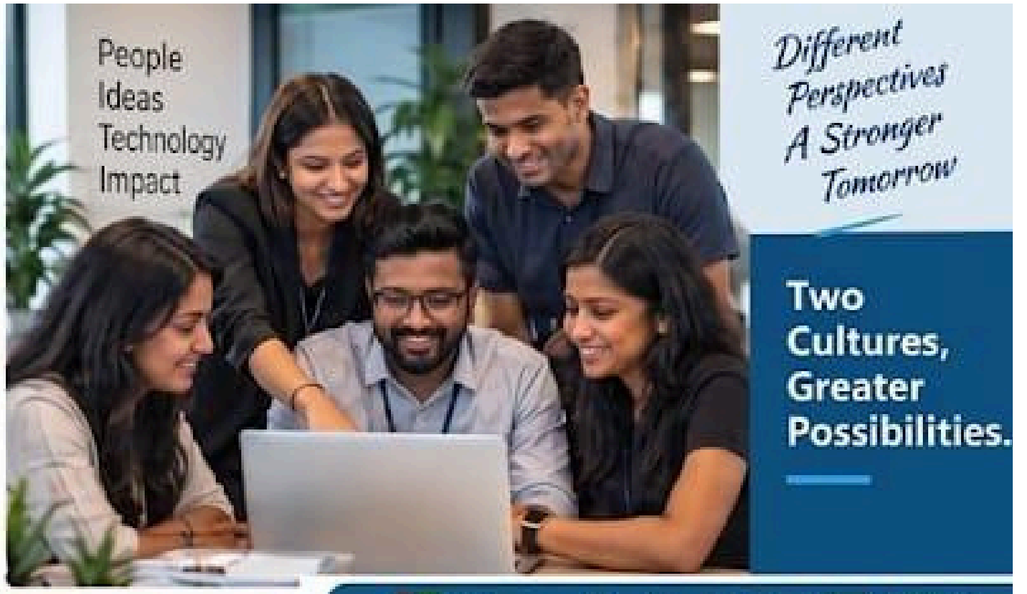
SHRM Dimension 6: Cultural and Employee Experience

Supporting: Global HR Integration, Leadership Pipeline and Performance and Rewards

Question: What cultural integration steps are critical to align Coforge's IT service culture with Encora's agile ethos?

Case Snapshot (Coforge - Encora)

~US$ 2.5B	~US$ 2B	3,100+	20–25%
Combined firm (expected run-rate)	AI, Data & Cloud (expected revenue in FY27)	Engineering & AI SMEs (Encora servicing US clients)	Expected G&A cost synergies



Cultural Integration Plan

From understanding to a unified, high-performance culture.

1 Assess Culture
- Surveys & interviews
- Compare communication decision-making & work styles

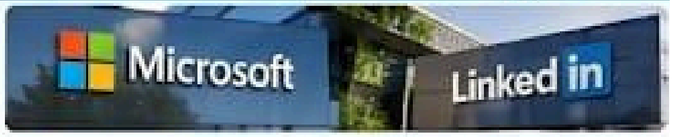
2 Build Shared Values
- Innovation, collaboration & agility
- Co-create common behaviours

3 Preserve What Works
- Retain Encora's agile practices
- Scale successful practices across teams

4 Integrate People
- Mixed Coforge-Encora teams
- Buddy/mentor programs
- Joint projects & knowledge sharing

Microsoft | LinkedIn (2016)

A well-known example of cultural integration



- Blended teams & leadership from both companies
- LinkedIn's open, flexible work culture merged with Microsoft's structured approach
- Focused on shared values like innovation, customer impact and growth

Conclusion

A successful cultural integration will help Coforge and Encore conthine their strengths, build a people-first and innovation-driven culture, and create a stronger, future-ready organization.

People | Collaboration | Innovation
A Stronger Future

EMPLOYEE MORALE DURING MERGER UNCERTAINITY

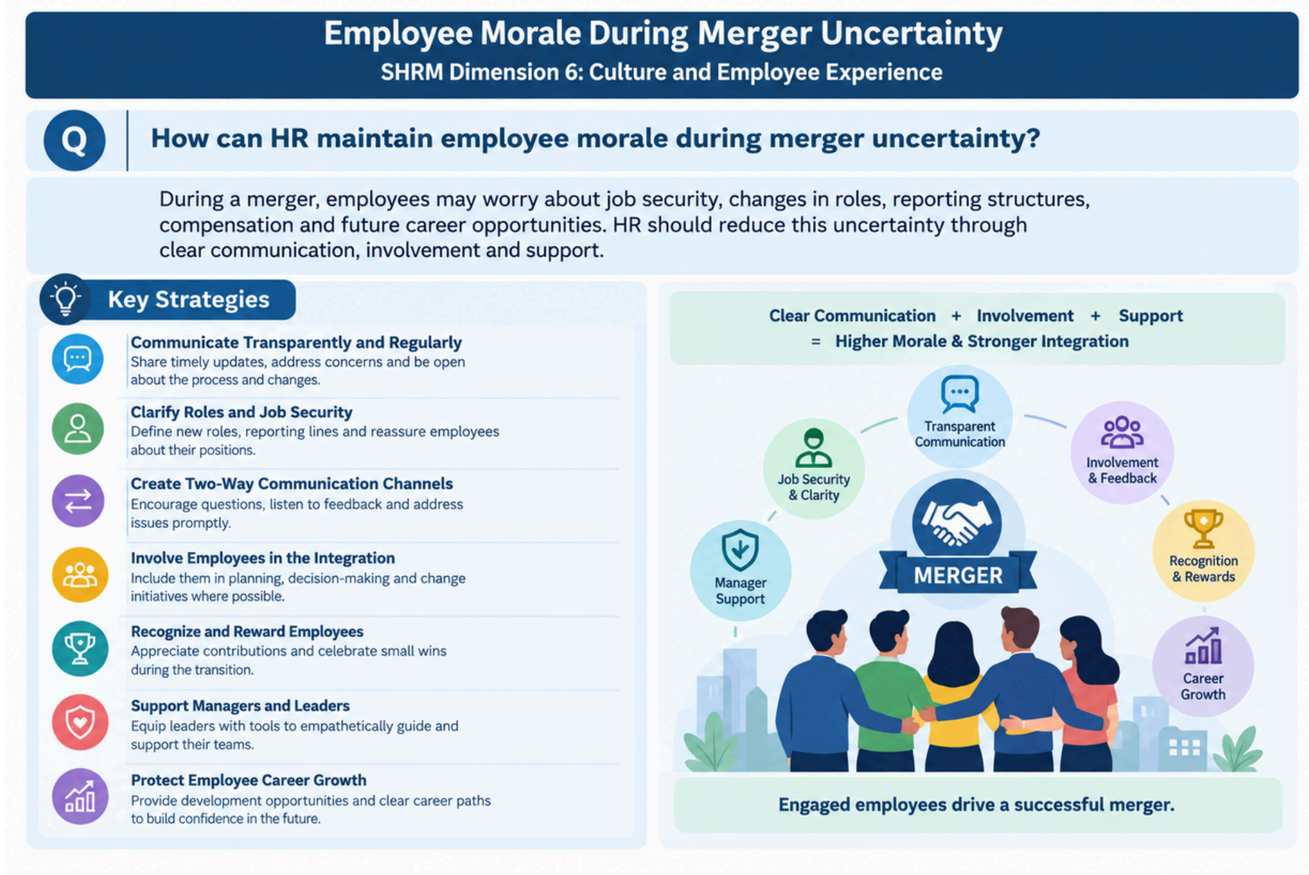
SHRM Dimension 6:Culture and Employee Experience

Question: How can HR maintain employee morale during merger uncertainty?

During a merger, employees may worry about job security, changes in roles, reporting structures, compensation and future career opportunities. HR should reduce this uncertainty through communication, involvement and support.

Key strategies:

- Communicate transparently and regularly
- Provide clarity about roles and job security
- Create two-way communication channels
- Involve employees in the integration
- Recognize and reward employees
- Support managers and leaders
- Protect employee career growth



Coforge × Encora: Harmonizing Pay & Performance

SHRM Dimension 4: Performance Management and Rewards

Question : What risk arise in harmonizing pay scales and performance systems across India, US and Latin America?

THE SITUATION | Different pay, KPIs and appraisal practices now need to work together across three regions.

WHY HARMONIZATION IS RISKY

01 Pay equity
Market salaries may differ across countries.

02 Legal fit
Tax, benefits and employment rules vary by market.

03 Different work styles
Teams may use different review practices.

04 Talent loss
Unfair changes may push out key talent.

05 Rating bias
Managers may judge similar work differently.

06 Change fatigue
Too fast = resistance.
Too slow = confusion.

FIRST 12 MONTHS | ALIGN, DON'T REPLACE

Compare, align, try and improve — step by step, together.

Months 1–3 — Understand
- Compare current roles, KPIs, review rules, pay approaches and local legal requirements.

Months 4–6 — Align
- Agree on shared values, 1–2 common KPIs and common communication.

Months 7–9 — Try
- Use the shared approach with selected teams, train managers and gather feedback.

Months 10–12 — Improve
- Fix gaps, check fairness and prepare the final company-wide design.

Not yet: salary bands · bonus % · promotion rules

AFTER 12 MONTHS | HARMONIZE

Build a common performance system with local flexibility.

01 Job Structure
Create common job levels and role definitions across the company.

02 Performance Process
Use common goals, review timing and rating principles.

03 Rewards
Follow one reward philosophy, while keeping country-specific pay, benefits and tax rules.

04 Check & Adjust
Review fairness, retention and business results every cycle.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Unilever

Unilever uses common reward principles across the globe, but adapts pay and benefits to local markets. This helps them stay fair, competitive and compliant in every country.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR COFORGE × ENCORA

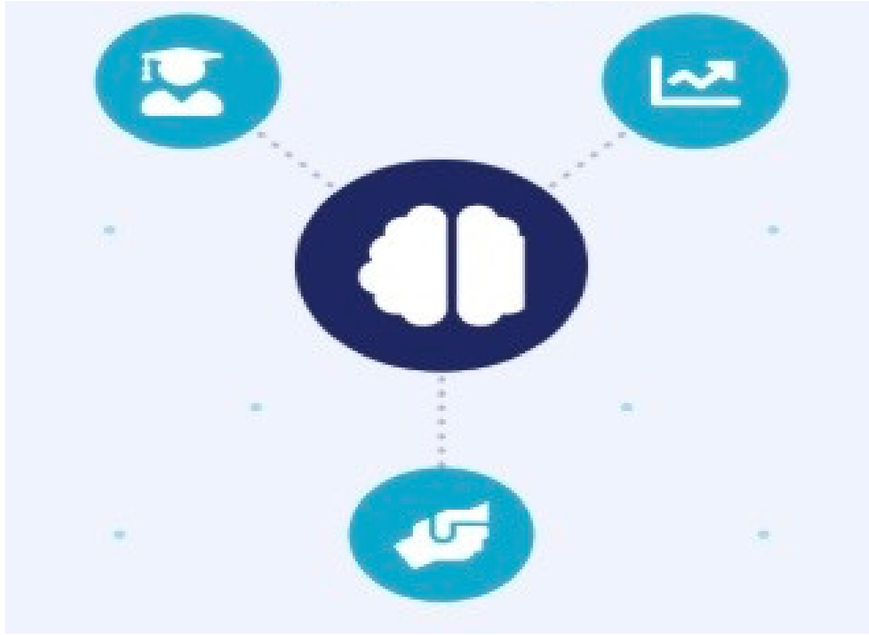
We can have a shared performance approach, while keeping pay, benefits and rewards local. This builds fairness, consistency and long-term retention.

One Framework. Local Pay. Global Impact.

AI Reskilling: Building Coforge's AI-Ready Workforce

Question: How can reskilling programs be designed to support AI adoption across Coforge's workforce?

Dimension 3: Learning & Development | Supporting: Workforce Planning • Strategie Alignment • Talent Retention



1. Assess Skill Gaps

Benchmark employee AI skills vs. business needs
— sort into basic, intermediate, advanced tracks.

2. Role-Based Learning Paths

IT → AIML & automation Data → analytics ||
Managers → AI strategy | Product → AI-based development.

3. Encora-Led Mentorship & Live Projects

Encora's AI experts train and mentor; employees apply learning on real AI projects, not courses alone.

4. Certify, Advance & Keep Learning

Certifications unlock new AI roles/promotions; ongoing workshops keep skills current as AI evolves.

Navigating Multi-Jurisdictional HR Compliance
SHRM Dimension 7: Global HR Integration

Question: How should HR navigate multi-jurisdictional labor laws and compliance requirements?

After the acquisition, Coforge will have employees across India, the US and Latin America. HR cannot simply apply one set of rules everywhere because employment laws, compensation requirements, benefits, working hours, taxation and employee rights differ by country.

DIMENSIONS

Global HR Integration
↕
Performance & Rewards
↕
Culture & Employee Experience
↕
Workforce Planning
↕
Strategic Alignment

If compliance issues emerge ⚖️

So the contingency plan would be:

- identify the country and nature of the violation.
- Involve local HR + Legal/Compliance.
- Stop or correct the non-compliant practice.
- Conduct a compliance review/audit to find whether the issue exists elsewhere.
- Update the policy/process.
- Train managers and HR teams to prevent recurrence.

Example

Unilever has a global HR structure called “One HR”, with global centres of expertise for areas such as talent, rewards, benefits, learning and people analytics, while HR Business Partners can operate at local, regional or global levels. Unilever HR teams support approximately 1,20,000 employees worldwide illustrating the scale at which its HR function is operating.


THANK YOU
Coforge
is People
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#EngageWithTheEmerging